Community Services and Public Safety Committee Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, April 6, 2026
2:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381179

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Bartholomew called the meeting to order at 2:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair David Bartholomew
Committee Vice-Chair Thomas Reitz
Committee Member York Glover
Committee Member Lawrence McElynn
Committee Member Anna Maria Tabernik
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Joseph Passiment

Absent
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Bartholomew led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Bartholomew stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Tabernik, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Reitz to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to approve the minutes from March 2, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:0.

6. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken

7. Assistant County Administrator Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381179

8. Presentation

a. Presentation from the Non-Toxic Neighborhoods - Kim Konte, Founder, Executive Director

The committee requested administration bring back a presentation regarding current pesticide practices, which are governed by Clemson Extension, and suggested areas for improvement. This is slated to come forward to the May 4th Community Services Meeting.

9. Agenda Items

a. An Ordinance to add a new Ordinance Section 54-8 Hate Intimidation Crime establishing the offense of hate intimidation and establishing a penalty for violations in the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Monica Main
Deputy County Attorney

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member McElynn to approve an Ordinance to add a new Ordinance Section 54-8 Hate Intimidation Crime establishing the offense of hate intimidation and establishing a penalty for violations in the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:0.

b. A Resolution of Beaufort County, South Carolina, encouraging the South Carolina General Assembly to adopt a Comprehensive Hate Crime Bill. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Monica Main

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member McElynn to approve a Resolution of Beaufort County, South Carolina, encouraging the South Carolina General Assembly to adopt a Comprehensive Hate Crime Bill.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:0.

c. 2026/06: An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the

county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain exceptions and limitations thereto.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on February 3, 2026 - 6:2
The vote at First Reading on February 23, 2026 - 7:4
Public Hearing was held on March 9, 2026
The vote to postpone Second Reading until the March 23, 2026 County Council Meeting - 10:0
The vote to send back to Community Service and Public Safety Committee for revisions at the County Council Meeting on March 23, 2026 - 11:0 **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - County Attorney Brian Hulbert

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve 2026/06 An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain exceptions and limitations thereto.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to amend having paragraph c.5. removed in its entirety and under penalties state a person who violates any provision of this article shall pay a civil penalty of no more than $500 for each penalty, and require them to attend a firearms safety course.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion to amend passed 9:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve 2026/06 An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain exceptions and limitations thereto as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The main motion passed 9:0.

d. A Resolution approving the Beaufort County Fleet Services policy - Public Access Vehicle Charging Station **(FISCAL IMPACT: No fiscal impact for approval of policy)** - John Robinson ACA / Todd Davis Fleet Services director 3 min.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve a Resolution approving the Beaufort County Fleet Services policy- Public Access Vehicle Charging Station.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:0.

10. Adjournment

Ratified: May 5, 2026